



Overthinking anyone?

Researchers have found that thinking causes some of your cancerous brain tumours to grow faster <http://dgit.in/CancerBrain>



Fun Fact

If you open up the case of the original Macintosh, you will find 47 signatures, which is of each member of Apple's Macintosh division of 1982.

Selfies

You knew this was coming. There are some things that you know are bad for you, yet you indulge in them now and then just because you enjoy it – they're called guilty pleasures. That 'Death by Chocolate' you just can't resist, the daily 'I'm quitting after this one' cigarette, or the odd Honey Singh song you stop humming just as you realise someone is going to hear you – all fall into this category. Almost all of these are understandable (even the Honey Singh one), considering how often these songs are played. But then, there are things that are inexcusable – selfies. Sure, we've all indulged in them at some point of time – blame peer pressure – but just the fact that they make such an easy target for all the narcissism and self-objectivism allegations ensures that we'll all remain hypocrites and condemn selfies. The nature of selfies has advanced

since its inception, and we've moved on from bathroom selfies to protest march selfies and road accident selfies. The gift of a selfie-stick today can be a genuinely thoughtful one, or an ironic jab, depending on who's doing the gifting. To make matters worse, there are now devices being made that can click selfies by just tapping them. Skynet is next, we're sure.

Annoyance Rating: ✓✓✓✓, but ✓ if the subject is an attractive individual who comes up with better captions than that 'misfits' quote by Steve Jobs

People who argue without reading the entire article

We're calling it right now – there'll be people reading this article who without having read the entirety of it would safely call the writer of this article pretentious and preachy without realising that this is a tongue-in-cheek article that's meant to be taken light-heartedly. They aren't reading this paragraph, so we took the liberty of saying it again. Combine this trait with the rise of clickbait titles, and you've got a recipe for hundreds of misguided comments under popular blogposts,

explaining how everything is wrong and the writer is an idiot. He may still be one, sure, but at least do us the favour of reading our work before branding us.

Annoyance Rating: ✓✓✓✓✓

Listicles

One of the more recent phenomena that has completely taken over our feeds. Absolutely every Facebook timeline is filled with people posting listicles, tagging their friends and going "1, 5, and 33 are soooo YOU :D :D :D !!!"

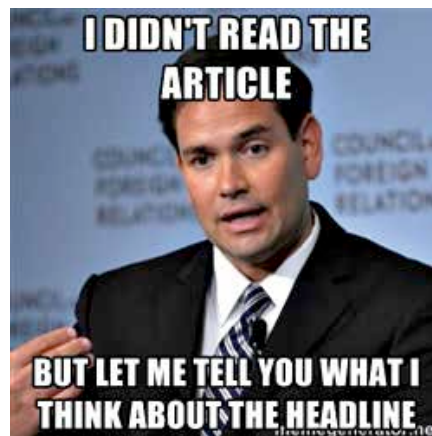
We know it's frustrating, but you've got to pause for a second and admire



Too many hashtags defeat the purpose

whoever reintroduced listicles in pop culture, for s/he is a genius – an evil genius, but a genius nonetheless. Listicles toy with the human mind in more ways than one. Let's look at...err...a list citing why listicles are so effective:

- 1. Numbers:** The human mind loves things that pop out and catch our eye – and numbers do exactly that. They also make you feel in control of the subject, and give you a false sense of mastery.
- 2. Images:** Just like with numbers, the



Opinionated folks are a dime a dozen



Don't be insulting – put that phone away

human mind grasps images and retains them for a lot longer. Listicles – by reducing on the amount of content – leave a lot of space for images, thus making them very attractive to a human mind that likes to locate and digest information spatially.

- 3. Makes you feel special:** By making a list of about 17 points, there are bound to be more than one that relates to more or less everyone, in turn indirectly making them feel more connected to the article.
- 4. Appeal to curiosity:** "Number 14 will blow my mind? Really? What's so special about number 14? Well I guess I'll just have to see for myself." Note that the item that's supposed to blow your mind is never in the first half of the list, and therefore requires you to quickly traverse at least half the list if you want to see it.

However, listicles have adverse effects on the human mind. They don't exercise your brain at all, proven by the fact that the average attention span of a human being now is eight seconds – one second less than that of a goldfish! We're finding it tougher to go through a wall of text now than we did two years ago. Further, since all articles containing disparate points, a need for structure in thought has diminished. Despite knowing all of this, we're sure to click the next clickbait listicle title and spend a precious two minutes on it. It's really a surprise the word 'gullible' isn't in the Oxford dictionary.

Annoyance Rating: "India's leading tech magazine gives rating on how annoying listicles are, and it will blow your mind!"

So, this was our list of the most annoying digital habits that people have. If you indulge in two or more of these, we encourage you to rethink your digital habits. #justkidding 